

Name: _____

Date: _____

NAPLAN Practice | Year 5 | Reading — Narrative, Informational and Persuasive Texts

LEARNING INTENTION

I am practising reading complex texts and answering comprehension, vocabulary, inference and author's purpose questions — at Year 5 NAPLAN level.

STRATEGY

Read the text TWICE. For inference questions, look for clues the author implies but does not directly state. For vocabulary questions, use the surrounding sentences to work out meaning.

WHY AUSTRALIA MUST ACT ON OCEAN PLASTIC — NOW

Every minute, the equivalent of a garbage truck full of plastic is dumped into the world's oceans.

Australia, surrounded by three oceans, is not immune to this crisis — our coastlines collect thousands of tonnes of plastic waste each year.

Unlike paper or food scraps, plastic does not biodegrade. Instead, it breaks into tiny fragments called microplastics.

These particles enter the food chain when marine animals mistake them for food — and ultimately, they end up on our dinner plates.

Some argue that individual action is enough: bring your own bag, refuse a straw, recycle your bottles.

However, research shows that just 20 companies produce 55% of the world's single-use plastic.

The real solution lies not in personal guilt, but in systemic change — governments must legislate, and corporations must be held accountable.

Australia has made a start with plastic bag bans, but far more ambitious action is urgently needed.

Our oceans are not a dumping ground. It is time we stopped treating them like one.

A — COMPREHENSION AND INFERENCE

1. What does the author mean by 'Australia is not immune to this crisis'?

- A Australia causes all ocean plastic pollution.
- B Australia is also affected by plastic pollution.
- C Australia is safe from ocean pollution.
- D Australia's oceans are the cleanest in the world.

2. What does 'systemic change' mean in this passage?

- A Changes made by individual people
- B Changes to the whole system — laws and corporations
- C Changes to the ocean environment
- D Changes to recycling bins

B — AUTHOR'S PURPOSE AND LANGUAGE

5. What is the MAIN purpose of this text?

- A To inform readers about how plastic is made.
- B To entertain readers with a story about the ocean.
- C To persuade readers that governments must act on plastic pollution.
- D To explain how recycling works in Australia.

6. The author says 'Our oceans are not a dumping ground.' What technique is this?

- A A simile
- B A rhetorical statement
- C A metaphor
- D Alliteration

7. The author mentions that 20 companies

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Answer Guide (For Parent / Teacher Use)

Q1: B — Australia is also affected by plastic pollution.

Q2: B — Changes to the whole system — laws and corporations.

Q3: C — Plastic does not biodegrade — it breaks into microplastics.

Q4: C — In the end.

Q5: C — To persuade readers that governments must act on plastic pollution.

Q6: B — A rhetorical statement (a strong declaration that challenges the reader's assumptions).

Q7: C — To support the argument that systemic change is needed — the problem is corporate, not individual.

Q8: B — Urgent and persuasive.

Q9: Accept: The author presents the opposing view (counterargument) first, then refutes it with evidence. This technique (concession + rebuttal) makes the author's argument more convincing.

Q10: biodegrade

Q11: Not balanced — the author clearly favours systemic/government change. Evidence (any 2): 'the real solution lies not in personal guilt, but in systemic change'; 'governments must legislate'; final sentence is a strong call to action; the counterargument about individual action is immediately dismissed.

High Five! You are a Language Champion! ✓
Colour a star for each section you completed successfully:



EXTENSION / CHALLENGE

Find a persuasive text (newspaper editorial, advertisement or letter to the editor). Identify: the author's position, two pieces of evidence used, one counterargument and the call to action.

PARENT TIP

Discuss the difference between **FACT** and **OPINION** in this text. Ask: 'Which sentences can be proven? Which are the author's views?' This develops critical reading skills.

TEACHER TIP

Use this for guided reading — model inference and author's purpose questions. These are the hardest question types in NAPLAN Year 5 reading.

STUDENT REFLECTION

[] I can identify the author's purpose and point of view in a persuasive text